

Interviewer: Okay. Alright. So, hello. Good afternoon. So, I will just mark the video. So, today is [Date], and I'm doing this interview with you in relation to our study on relationship quality. So, syempre, thank you so much for participating in this interview, and as I've mentioned through our chat messages and through them, this study is about romantic relationships, your views about romantic relationships, your experience and perspectives about romantic relationships would bring much to the project.

Interviewer: Okay. So, I'm now recording it, no? And we will only use the recording for transcription, and I also have my paper here, magno-notes din ako while we talk. Para I can summarize hopefully later, no? Brief summary lang. So, I will start with some basic demographic questions, okay? The first question is, if you don't mind, may I know how old you are?

Speaker: Oh, I'm [36-40]...uhm [36-40] years old.

Interviewer: [36-40].

Speaker: ...the third. [36-40] po.

Interviewer: Alright. So, and since this is about relationship, of course, the assumption is when [Name] recommended you, the assumption is you have a partner, no?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Yeah. And if I may ask, how long have you been together with your partner?

Speaker: I have [1-5] partners. The other one, my husband, I've been married to him for almost [6-10] years. And my other partner is, we just celebrated our [1st-5th] anniversary. Yeah.

Interviewer: So, does this mean that you've been together for [1-5] years or more? Like, when we recon the years in the relationship, pwedeng hindi necessarily during the married period lang or during... So, how would you quantify?

Speaker: The second partner, I've been with her for [1-5] romantically, but as a friend, of course.

Interviewer: You've known her already?

Speaker: Yes. I've known her for like [1-5] years.

Interviewer: Okay. So, thank you for that. Now, the next question is, do you have children?

Speaker: Yes. I do have [1-5] children, [gender] and a [gender].

Interviewer: Okay. So, in the household, the question is very general, no? But who lives in the household?

Speaker: Aside from me, my husband and my [1-5] children.

Interviewer: So, pwedeng general lang din ito, no? So, what is your main source of income? Or how would you refer to your job? or occupation?

Speaker: The main source of income comes from my husband because he has bigger salary compared to me.

Interviewer: But as for you, are you also employed?

Speaker: Yes. Currently, I'm employed. I'm a [occupation] at a... the name of the [company] is [company].

Interviewer: So, you're a [occupation] there in an [company]?

Speaker: Yes, in an [company].

Interviewer: Alright. So, you mentioned [1-5] partners. How would you like me to address your partner? Because you mentioned husband for the first one.

Speaker: And wife. And si wife.

Interviewer: And si wife.

Speaker: And si husband and si wife.

Interviewer: Alright. Okay. Para later when we talk about these questions and then we refer to a particular partner, malinaw which partner we refer to. Thank you.

Interviewer: Now, the next part of the interview is about a general, more like a context setting. So, can you tell me about your love story? So, here we refer to first the husband and then the wife.

Speaker: Okay. Si husband. We are like, we live in the same [location]. But we haven't seen each other for like, we never met, though we live in the same [location], basically. And then one day, because I am by profession before I'm a [occupation], I was doing some kind of [occupation]. I went to a field near a school and then I saw people playing [sport]. So, yung [sport] na yung nilalaro ni [artist] before. So, I was, I love sports. So, basically I was like, captivated about the game. And then suddenly he came, invited me to somehow...that was the day that they have a sort of competition, a mini tournament. And they were like...asked me if I could [occupation] them as a group. So, that was the first time that I met him.

Speaker: And then from there, they kind of invited me over to join them because I love sports. And if I have free time, I usually go there. And then, and I get to know him, he's a nice person. The children, usually kasi yung kasama niya doon sa ano... parang mga youth, mga out of school youth kasi yung dinidevelop nila doon sa ano...So, that they would be away from drugs and all of that. So, I kind of hang out with them. And then from there, we usually talk. And then yung suddenly, like, like, there's like... Okay, I just, okay, how do you explain that? Just one day, he was like, you know, just playing on the field and you were just there observing. And then you have that moment where kind of literally it's slow motion. And then like the world shook and I was like, okay, what just happened? And then, you know, I never thought of it that way. Just that, you know, you usually talk to him. Like you just talk for how many weeks and then suddenly like, okay, what just happened? Like suddenly you just notice someone beyond, you know, your friend or your being colleagues with him.

Speaker: He's like, oh, he said, I never noticed that. Like this one moment, I think he was like trying to capture a [sport]. And I was like, sorry, it's a little cheesy. Like really, it was cheesy. Every time I tell people about it, like, dude, it sounds like, you know, you're a hallmark movie right now. And I know it's so cheesy really.

Interviewer: So it's something that you didn't see coming?

Speaker: No, I never thought I would look at him that way. I had respect with it. When you respect a person with that, you know, like organizing youth to help them, you know, try to help them na. Hindi sila maaano sa drugs. You want to help the youth. I never thought about that. You know, maybe I respect the person and I never thought I would have that, you know, suddenly like slow motion and then the world shook. In that there's... it's really cheesy. It's like the toothpaste commercial or something like that.

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: So there was a moment that you realized that it's not just mere friendship anymore, something like that. Just something that.. it just happened that way. Oh, okay. Parang kinilig ka bigla after that moment.

Interviewer: How long was that? So from the time that you met, from the time that you said that you met when you were doing [occupation], right? And then, so how long was that span of time before you actually became a couple?

Speaker: Um, a couple. I think mga, siguro mga [6-10] months pa at yan after that. Kasi nga, the thing was I had just broke up with my ex and then I was like, you know, going outside because I was like depressed and, you know, [occupation] always makes me happy. So we go somewhere that makes you happy and then, and then he came and then yun parang...Okay. [redacted]. I just had sort of parang yung nanonormalize mo nga yung life mo after relationship. Kasi nga, you just get out from a relationship and then you don't kind of want to go back into a relationship because you don't want to complicate things.

Interviewer: So anything else? So that's the meeting and the development came in after that moment that you realized that there's something.

Speaker: But actually nangligaw siya before like, kasi we started our relationship mga [Month] at saka, tapos na. I think it happened mga, I think it's like around... maybe [Month] na nangligaw talaga siya. But I even laughed at him at first when it's like, he just wrote something like, I love you and I was like, what? And then are you serious? And I was laughing and I never thought that he was serious about it. But I tried to explain that I'm not really ready to have a relationship right now, though I never hinted that I like him, but I just said like, I'm not ready to have a relationship. So it's like, it happened and then [Month] came and then, well, it's just that, you know, when you realize that you really like someone and you're just like, you want it to be with that person. So yun, ako na yung naghabol. Basically, parang ako na yung nangligaw after that, like, okay, I'm not ready and after that ako na naghabol na kanya.

Interviewer: Because nga you said initially that you're not yet ready.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: And then when you're ready, of course.

Speaker: Okay. Ako na yung nangligaw.

Interviewer: Alright. Okay. So how about for the wife? How was the love story? What's the love story behind your relationship?

Speaker: I don't know. Weird kasi, because I never met my wife like physically met her. We were friends, cyber friends, we're online friends because of my wonderful kambal ng tadhana. I call her my twin. Anyways, my twinie. She made a parang isang group chat ng mga avid [Social Media] ng isang fan fiction. So lahat kami nag sign in doon. Everybody's happy and friendly and all. And then I never thought I would like her. Because una sa lahat, she's way younger than I am. And then she's far away. And ano pa ba? Yeah, she's basically not near my universe. Where I usually yung parang gagala-galala ka sa universe na yun. Ayun malayo sya. So yun.

Speaker: So I never thought that I would like her that way. But we like a lot of things. Gaya din ng parter ko na isa. We like certain aspects of things like reading. Mga ganun. Kasi nga LGBT din sya. We understand each other like things like about yung struggles being in the community. Ganyan. And then mostly kasi, you know, advocacy-wise. Pareho kasi kami so ganun. So I have been close to her as her friend. But seriously yung when COVID hits parang hindi kami nakacomunicate talaga. There's like a few hi, hello, and like that. But never really had a conversation for how many months. And then suddenly she just chat me at [Social Media] and told me to watch a TV series. Na yung warrior nun. So I was like, oh god, another TV series and I have to...oh god. And I was like "do I need to watch it?" And she's like, "please do watch it. I promise you it's good." And I was like, "okay, I'm really busy right now." And she was like, "it's okay. You can just, you know, just watch it once a week" or something like that. She's pushy about it. And I was like, okay. And then yun, doon kami nag-reconnect talaga. After ilang, almost [1-5] at ata siyan nawala. Or [1-5] years din yun. And then yun, we did talk about the series and what I think about it. And yun. And then I do have a crush on her already before pa.

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: Let's just have it on paper. I already like her as a person. Kasi nga, similar advocacies. Mga ganyan. Other than, you know, LGBT, yung mga advocacies like-Kasi sa [Country] siya. So yung mga [Advocacy], ganyan. Yung mga social na mga talaga...We connect about that one. Yun.She's also being helpful, yun. Trying to, if yung may mga problema kaya, she would suggest if she could help you, something like that. Yun. Parang nakacrush na ako sa kanya dati pa. But, yun know, I always think that, oh, she's just being nice because she's a friend, you know. You always like, oh, they're just being nice because they're your friend and they're polite and nice because they're a friend.And then, you know, watching that series, parang yun. Parang yun time na kasi dun eh. Yung parang nagpahiwatig ng something. Because I know that the protagonist is best friends with a lesbian person. And then, she was like, I hope that my best friend would look at me like [Name] is staring at her best friend right now. Yung chat niya. Tapos sabi ko, teka teka. Because I know that she thinks of me as her best friend because she's not really a people's person. And she always repeats that, oh, you're my best friend like that. Parang, okay. Parang nagpahiwatig siya na ganon. So, I was like, ay. And then, I did clarify and ask her about that. And I told her that, you know, my situation and this, I only have a family and things like that. But she knows that I'm a polite person and then I told her that I cannot make the decision right now. I have to ask my partner about this.And I didn't really tell her that I like her in any certain way. But after I asked my partner about it, then he said it's okay. And so, yeah, I asked her if I could date her and then it started that way. Yeah.

Interviewer: Alright.

Speaker: Ano lang... Siguro yun funny part lang. Because there was something that I wrote like [1-5] years ago, [1-5] years ago. Parang yung, I cannot say it word for word lang. Parang context that, "one

day, you'll find someone. You know, they don't need to be near you or close to you. But one day, you'll find someone and that someone would accept and love you.” Parang hindi ko naman in-expect na ako pala yun. At tawa lang kami, nung nireveal na namin yung, oh, it's time na ng friendship na nireview namin yung past, yung past chats namin. Ito parang dami kong tanong. I was too sweaty after I was like, I didn't realize I would be like the person in that. I was just trying to be your friend and then suddenly yung naganap, e, ako pala yung tao na yun. Parang ganun. At tawa lang nang tawa kami. Yeah, that was like funny, in a sense, na kinikilig ka din.

Interviewer: So, um, so that was like, so you've been friends for just to recall, no? So you were friends for about [1-5] years. Because, of course, yung common ground niyo, yung parang naging basis for the attraction, friendship pa lang. And then the reconnection, instrumental yung series, I suppose. Okay, and then, so, um, and then you celebrated your [1-5] year already. So before you, so that was like, so doing the math, like [1-5] years kayo as friends, in a way as close friends, and then [1-5] years after.

Speaker: No, actually talagang kami, [1-5] years kami as friends, and [1-5] kami as a couple. Parang [1-5] years na kami magkakilala ganiyan.

Interviewer: Okay. So thank you for clarifying. So anything else you'd like to add about the love story?

Speaker: Ano lang, yung si wife kasi, grabi daw yung pag...what do you call that... pag friend zone ko daw sa kaniya. She was like, you friend zoned me so hard, that I thought I'm not going to be able to get away from that zone. Because I was like, well, I didn't know that you liked me. You never discussed that. Because you've kind of been like, disappeared for the longest time and we never talk about it. And she was like, I like you because you have that personality. And yeah, yun lang siguro yung added part lang dun.

Interviewer: So parang yung common dun, at least looking at the story of the husband and the wife, parang it started with some form of friendship in a way, for both individuals. So thank you.

Interviewer: So the next questions would focus more on one is of course relationship quality. So to ask questions about it, I'd like to first ask you to compare the quality of your current relationships to that of your friends' relationships. So if it's okay for you to compare, it doesn't have to be one is better or the other is not. It doesn't have to be in that way. But in terms of quality, how would you compare it?

Speaker: Most of my friends are really political people. Very political, highly political. Though they're not [Nationality], they're very much active in situations and politics in their countries. Yung ano ko naman, yung isang partner ko, he's the type of person na, yes, he kind of talks about it but not really dwell on it. Parang passing lang yung situations like politics and things like that. Hindi naman talaga siya yung nagdidig up. Hindi talaga siya yung tipo.

Speaker: I want to make a sort of help this type of like parang may campaign, like something that like yung “Palestinian free”.. Palestinian thingy. He kind of hates how the Jews treated the Palestinian pero wala naman siyang ginagawa. If my friends would be like, oh, don't worry, we're asking around for NGOs that support the press that are trying to expose what is going on in Gaza and things like that. Yung isang partner ko din, she understands and somehow in a way, it might sort of make a... yung parang tutulong siya ganyan pero due to the fact that she's too busy with work, parang she forgets sometimes but in a way that yung ano lang niya is that, “I will not support yung organizations and companies that are

allowing this type of oppression to Palestinian people,” yung ganun tipo. So yung mga ganon lang... yung difference siguro.

Interviewer: So let me clarify. So with your friends, more on the relationship quality of your friends' relationships parang ganun, if I'm getting it correctly that their relationships are more based on political similarities, something like that..advocacies.

Speaker: Yes, oo.

Interviewer: And as far as your concern, let's say your relationship with your husband as well as with your wife. Meron ding politics involved pero hindi kasing..

Speaker: – ganun ka lalim.

Interviewer: How about in terms of...kumbaga yung inherent na..kung saan drawn yung relationships nila compared to kung saan drawn yung relationships mo. But halimbawa, let's say in terms of other, sabihin natin, dimensions of relationship quality. May iba ka pa bang napapansin?

Speaker: Yung ano lang, isang partner... yung husband ko, yung he is not really very vocal about when he talks about his emotions, parang ganun. Pero when you talk, when you needed him, he's gonna be physically be there. Yung, he's not the type of person yung parang PDA type. And then, yung friends ko naman ay mga medyo PDA na mga tao, kasi parang okay lang sa culture nila, ganun. Sa atin kasi medyo conservative pa din tayo ganun. Sa kanila hindi.

Interviewer: Okay. Alright. So now, still a bit more on relationship quality. So you mentioned earlier that you had an ex, di ba? So you were like, getting over an ex before, no? So I'm assuming that based on that narrative, that you had partners in the past. You had partners in the past or partners in the past. So now the comparison is, your current comparison, if you can please compare the quality of your relationship with your husband and your wife at the moment, no? To that of your previous, so yung mga ex naging ex mo. So how would you compare?

Speaker: Actually lang, I don't feel comfortable around them, my exes. I don't feel very comfortable. Yung lang yung, I don't feel security when I'm around them.

Interviewer: Even when you were together with them?

Speaker: Yes, with my exes. Hindi ganun yung level na yung security na na na feel ko yung wala kung, parang may sense of anxiety. Every time I'm with them, parang may anxiety ako. But with my partners, I feel calm. Yung parang, you're not like, parang, well you don't have fear of something. Yung parang, parang may order in the universe. You're not in a chaotic, parang mindset when I am with them.

Interviewer: It's a quotable quote. It's ordering the universe. Alright, as compared to previous relationships where it triggers your anxiety, not that comfortable and the feeling of security is not present as well. Now, still on relationship quality, but this time, I'd like to ask you, how would you describe a relationship that's high quality versus let's say, a low quality relationship?

Speaker: Siguro ano lang. Pag sinabi mo kasi relationship is more on, for me, is the sense of security. Yung parang wala kang, parang, at peace ka, peace of mind na you are with these people. Siguro lang, it's more on siguro, baka mature na din ako dun sa punto na yun na panang gusto mo yung enough drama, yung ganun, ayoko nung klaseng relationship that there's like drama and all of that. Gusto ko

lang yung peaceful na, it falls into place. Yung parang, you do not force something into your relationship for our relationship to work. But you just, slowly just, yung everything just falls into place lang talaga, yung ganun na, na parang it's not really that compromising.

Speaker: Yung parang kasi before kasi my exes, my god, you have to compromise to.. I have to be the one who will compromise for them. Yung parang sacrifices talaga. If you talk about sacrificing, ganyan, it always be on my side na ako yung dapat mag-sacrifice o mag-give up dun sa part na yun so that the relationship would work. Parang ganun. But in my current, yung relationship ko kasi ngayon is, I don't need to compromise, because everybody is on the same page, but you know, though you're on the same page, dapat pag-usapan pa din kasi yung you have to be on the same page.

Interviewer: So, just to make a follow up, so, since you've described a bit on high quality, no? A high quality relationship, that sense of security, there's peace, there's that maturity, everything falls into place, and then you mentioned a bit on compromising in your previous relationships as well as making sacrifices. Would you, would you be correct to say that these are the indicators naman of low quality relationship?

Speaker: Oh, yung mag-sacrifice ka, for a relationship to work that's definitely low quality, and it would be toxic in the, in the long run. Kasi nga, you're the one who's compromising while the other is forcing you na to adjust for them. Parang ganun pa.

Interviewer: Thank you. Right. So, now given these things that you mentioned you mentioned some key points, but if I were to ask you again, no? What do you think would be the most important things in a relationship and, and why?

Speaker: So, siguro lang, ano, in a relationship talaga is that, you know, you have to be honest talaga in, in the conversations. Kasi nga, you have to be on the same page in, especially sa relationship ko, I have [1-5] partners. And I have to, you know...you have to be honest with each other kung ano ba talaga yung papatutunguhan natin, what are our directions? Kasi nga, we're in a relationship. So, I have to know kung ano ba talaga yung direction natin so that I would be prepared. And, yes, though parang, ano talaga siya parang hindi naman, ano talaga importante, but if it comes to a point that we have to meet halfway, hindi naman compromise, but meet halfway, we will do that, diba.

Interviewer: Okay. So, ang key point na sinabi mo is the honesty in the conversation and being clear about ano yung direction nyo for the relationship...and it's important to always be on the same page. Now, moving on to the next, to the next part of the interview, ito medyo pang slambook ang style, pero, I'd like to ask, for you, what is love?

Speaker: Ang lalim. Everybody would, I don't know, siguro lang, if, if you're gonna ask me, talagang malalim na question, but it's a simple question, but malalim siya. Siguro lang, love for me is just that, you know, accepting who you are, whether or not yung positive or negative side mo, they would see you as a person na hindi, hindi lang maganda kung hindi yung pangit din na side sayo, and they would accept you and still be with you yung ganon.

Interviewer: Alright, so a true measure of love is if there's really full acceptance, both good and bad, right? So, anything else? Okay.

Speaker: Siguro, ano lang yun, yun yung kasi yung nafi-feel ko, kasi ngayon...I'm in a relationship with the, you know, the both partners of somehow that level of acceptance, but I'm not. I am like this, so I don't know if you could accept me as this person, but I'm like, I'm telling them that I'm not gonna hold you down if you want, if you want to go and think that, you know, this isn't for you, I'm not gonna stop you. Yung ganon. Kung hindi niyo kaya ang tanggapin ako as this person, you know.

Speaker: And, and they still stayed. Siguro yun lang yung na-feel ko na, talagang these people accepted you and even though like, like my husband, he's not really a poly person. Unlike my wife, she's poly. She understands the concept and how it, it kind of works. But husband is, isn't really poly. But he's, he's trying. He's very understanding about it and yun yung, siguro yung level ng acceptance yun about who I am. It's just, I, I cannot. Yung, eh, grabe yung, siguro parang sakaniya, it's really alien for him to, to be in, in this type of setup pa, na may isang tao that is part of, of, of as in, relationship na 'to you know, part ng relationship namin. There's another person that is alien sa kanya. But still he's here. He accepted that part.

Interviewer: Yeah. All right. So thank you for that, no? So kung baga pa rin, through that example, no, how you elaborated it, it's really clear, no, that love is about, yeah, that pure acceptance, no? Regardless, baga. Of course, it's not an easy thing to do.

Speaker: Yeah.

Speaker: Yeah, there are times sa magseselos yun, because they're entitled to when they feel na, parang, okay, parang you, you ignore me na. So, yeah, they would, they would somehow make you...they would show you na kung magseselos din sila, that you're in a relationship with them, that they want, you know, the feeling of security that you'd use, they love them, you know, they want to feel that. So, yun.

Interviewer: Okay. So, given that definition of love, hey, how important is love in a relationship? So, yeah, you defined it as acceptance, right? So, how important is that ingredient of love in a relationship?

Speaker: It's like, kasi pag wala yun, without kasi yung love na yun, sinasabi nating acceptance of your whole being. I don't think a relationship, a true relationship in an essence of a relationship, like It would not stand, it will not form in the first place, because parang, though you have maybe physical relationship, but somehow, emotionally, you would be detached to those people if wala yung acceptance, meaning yung love talaga. They would be, yung parang, siguro, you will have a relationship, maybe a physical or a sexual relationship with a person.

Speaker: But when you talk about a relationship, talagang yung relationship that is in a sense that you would be with these people for eternity or the longest time. You need that. You need something to hold on to. Other than, yes, physical aspect. Yeah, they're very attractive. Part naman siya, pero without love talaga. It would be very superficial, and it will not last long. Kasi nga, tiba, kasi nga, if you're only just basing it through physical intimacy or something like that, you could have a partner for a week or two and that's it. And you move on. Different kasi yung parang may love talaga, because you feel like you belong, like you're, you felt home.

Interviewer: So given that importance of love, no, and although partly paran medyo na sagut mo tung next question, you said that there's that acceptance, no, but ikaw personally, if I would ask you again, how do you know that your partner loves you?

Speaker: Well, siguro.

Interviewer: Excuse me, excuse me.

Speaker: Okay lang.

Speaker: Siguro nga, you, you felt that, you know, nilang yung sasabihin na, but you felt that every day that yung, yun bang they care that whatever you feel, yung change ng mood mo, yung mga ganoon na, they would be somehow like notice it, like ganyan. And they would be very, yung parang madidisturb din sila pag wala ka sa mood, ganyan. They would care about you in a sense that yung ano yung na-feel mo every day. And they would ask you how was your day?

Interviewer: Okay, so kung baga, there's that sensitivity, kasi if you say that you can feel your mood and about your day, about how you're feeling, parang there's that kind of sensitivity on their part. When you feel that, you say that there's that love. You feel that love for you.

Interviewer: Right. So, aside from, of course, the idea of love, it's very pleasant to think about love, but love is, or a relationship is not always about the good things, the good stuff in love. So, sometimes there's conflict as well.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: What would you say are the challenges in your relationships?

Speaker: Siguro lang yung pagbabalance nung relationship kasi nga [1-5] yung, ano, yung partners ko. So, it's not easy. Like, it's not even easy to have a relationship with a person, how much more with [1-5] people. Parang ganon yong times two yung ano mo diba. So, it's, the balancing between the [1-5] and yung kasi yung isa na feel nila na parang, parang hindi na balance ganyan... nagseselos na yan, kasi nga na leleft out sila they felt left out. So, you're trying, you're trying your best that they will not feel na they are left out.

Interviewer: Okay. So, in terms of let's say these conflicts, so just to probe a bit on this, do you and your partners fight, like with your husband, or you with your wife, are there any kinds of fights?

Speaker: See, husband kasi, kasi nga, he's still trying to understand what is this type of relationship, na yung polyamory, kasi nga, he's not really a person who wants to have that type of relationship. It's not for him. So, yun magseselos siya, of course, yan, but I have to be there and reassure him na, I'm not going to be like, I'm not going to leave you... basta-basta ganoon, ganoon nalang, it's not like you are a, parang yung, I have a replacement for you, yung na-feeling, parang may replacement agad ako, yan, it's not like that.

Speaker: And then, I always have yung one time, yung parang, kasi yung first time, yung na-feel niya na parang, he thought that I'm not, I don't love him anymore, ganyan, I told him that, you know what, love is not about, you know...about loving, you know, yung parang hindi mawawala yung love, for me ha, kasi kasi experience ko, hindi mawawala yung love ko sa isang tao, just because I fall in love with another person. Yung yung pinapaano ko sa kanya na, I fall in love with you because of who you are. Not because of another person, because I don't love them, that's why I fall in love with you, hindi ganon. It's about you, as a person. At yung yung, parang isa sa mga, ano ko talaga sa kanya na, you know, you have to clarify that, you have to reassure them that, I'm not gonna leave you, yung parang ganon, kasi nga,

they're not into poly relationship, yung kasi sila yung parang "Mayron na siyang iba, I would be left out," so I need to reassure him, almost like, every time, he felt like he's left out, na, I'm not leaving you, okay. You know, with or without na, may mga anak tayo ganyan, if I'm in a relationship with you, I'm in a relationship with you, because of as a person. Hindi kasi dahil, I fell in love with another person, mawawala na yun. Maybe if it changed, that I cannot accept, as a, a changed person, yung personality mo na, hindi ko na talaga matatanggap, maybe, that would be the time that I might not love you. Pero it doesn't mean that, may, nagusto na kong ibang tao, that I will not love you anymore.

Interviewer: So, these fights halimbawa these misunderstanding, so, how frequent would this be? Like, are they frequent?

Speaker: Siguro ano lang, um, yung time lang siguro na parang early stage pa ng relationship that he was still adjusting, you know, yung parang gusto lang yun, talaga yung may reassured siya. Kasi yun, natatakot siguro siya na, baka iwan ko, gan'un. I understand naman. And then, yun, siguro lang, though, after a year, siguro sa relationship ko, nafeel siguro niya na, okay, my wife is still here, so parang, hindi na siya ganon nagseselos talaga. And, and honestly, seems like nothing has changed in our relationship. Parang, ganun pa rin yung relationship namin, before my wife came, parang wala lang talaga. Yung major disruption sa kanya, other than, I have another person with me, and he knows that. And he did approve about it, so parang, like, like, you know, he would just, siguro adjustment period lang talaga, like, at that time. But right now, wala namin kami, yung mga discussion about that, kasi nga parang, yung, ano na, parang, nakita siguro niya na, it's not about, like, talagang yung iniisip niya.

Interviewer: So, but, as for your wife, how about her? Do you, we have fights as well?

Speaker: My wife is really not, right now, isn't really a problem. You know, she's very understanding. Sometimes, I feel guilty because she always readjust everything for me, like, her schedules and, and she would even stay up late at night for me and I would tell her that you don't have to do that. Sometimes, I could do that for you. Things like that. She's too understanding about the whole thing.

Speaker: Maybe lang yung early stage siya parang, yung, gabing, nagseselos yung husband ko, that there's a point na parang, she's scared. Yung ano, parang, over-thinker kasi si wife, parang nag eescalate sa head niya yung mga, mga bagay bagay. Sabi ko naman, it's okay, we're okay, I'm fine, ano lang, may misunderstanding lang talaga. And it's really, you know, hard for my husband to adjust because nga, the type of relationship that I have right now, isn't really that popular in a Christian side of the country na, di ba, na marami ang partners, it's alien to them. So I keep on telling her that we just, you know, have to be patient, don't yung parang, wag ka lang mag-over-think, just calm down, ganyan.

Speaker: But, but honestly, I don't have a problem with my wife because she's the romantic type, yung writer, still yung mga writers na romantic sila.

Interviewer: Alright, so, so, this means yung mga misunderstanding mas ano muna dun kay husband. So, in general, so when you get into these kinds of misunderstandings, so you said na, you reassure, but how would you describe yung resolution of the fights? How do you actually resolve the fight or the misunderstandings?

Speaker: Siguro lang, we talk, you know, really talk about it, like ano yung problema, like, which part ba talaga yung problema doon. You have to dissect, di ba kung ano talaga yung source ng ganun, para malaman mo kung ano yung irereassure mo sa kanila. So usually you find out about yung, ano lang,

yung takot na baka iwan mo sila, yun. So you, you tell them. Yeah, they didn't stop when I told them, I'm not gonna leave you, you're not being replaced. Yeah, I told them, you're not, because he was like, "So, I'm being replaced," and I'm like, "you're not being replaced." "So I'm the replacement," "you're not the replacement." And then, "you're my husband," something like that na you have to reassure them. Like you're husband and she's wife, so there's difference with you, because he's husband and she's wife.

Interviewer: So, so aside from this, so mainly ba, tama ba yung intindi ko? So the conflict resolution response in a way is really more on how you, how you try to handle it through, through conversation, through this kind of deep conversation of reassurance. So tama naman ba yung interpretation na yun?

Speaker: Opo.

Interviewer: But are there other ways? So aside from, kasi ito, mas ang nature nung talking na ito is more on kapag may mga conflicts nga or fights, no? But are there other ways that you maintain your relationships with them?

Speaker: Siguro ano lang, as much as possible, yung relationship with my husband is yung parang nothing has changed, yung ganon. Yung you want to show them that normal pa rin yung pakikitungo mo sa kanya, yung before another relationship and after meron ka ng another relationship. Yun yung pinapakita mo yun na, in the long run, it's not like I am totally ignoring you may mga times pa din na kinakalabit mo yun na, you can massage me, you can still touch my body, ganiyan. Mga ganyan ba na baka sabihin nila na ay may iba ka na, ayaw mo na sa'kin mga ganon. So, the physical intimacy is still there, you still want them na, yes, you can still touch me, kiss me, pero ganon, si Aspen kasi ayaw talaga niyang mag-kiss, mag-initiate ng kiss. So, it's on my side to initiate things.

Interviewer: So, in a way parang, yung maintain the relationship through, of course, yung show off, sabihin natin this show off love in a way, physical intimacy, mga ganyan.

Speaker: Yung mga affection mo sa kanila. Yung mga may sakit sila, of course, you have to take good care of them, yung mga ganyan. Somehow, you make them feel that, they're important, yung mga bagay na ganyan.

Interviewer: Would you say that this relationship is good for you? So, you have [1-5]o partners. So, would you say that both relationships are good for you?

Speaker: I think it's good, yung may magandang effect siya towards me personally. Siguro lang, ano lang yung na-feel ko talaga that, I have a family that really loves me. Yun nga, kasi nga, it's really sometimes hard na to be in a relationship like this na may multiple partners ka, but then, after a year in this relationship, maybe nasasabi ko lang na, maybe, I feel talaga na they probably really love me in that sense. Parang, yung maganda siya, yung magada yung effect niya. Tapos I have also, sometimes, if hindi mo naka-kausap yung isa nang may problema ka, kasi nga, you still have another partner that you can talk to. Yung parang...okay, parang, I almost got into an accident. So, you can't reach the other partner. So, you have another partner that you can reach. Pero yung, nag-aanxiety ka na nung nanginginig nginig ka na. So, you want someone to calm you down and you're trying to contact...something like that na, you know, sense of security lang ganon.

Interviewer: All right. Okay. So, so anyway, so in general, it's good for you. So, both relationships are good for you. You feel that love and that security from this relationship. And in terms of your day-to-day function, like, what do you think are, let's say, the contributions of these relationships to you?

Speaker: In a day-to-day...Can you rephrase the question, please?

Interviewer: Like, for example, when you say that, because in general, your answer was, it's good for you. You know, the relationships are good for you. And you qualify that by saying that you feel that there's security and, of course the support that you get from both partners or either kung sino available din na partner. But yung parang kumbaga na daily, like, for example, in a day, how do you feel that this relationship is good for you? So, not in a not in a grand way, but maybe on a day to day.

Speaker: Siguro nga, ano lang, it helps me lower my anxiety levels. Kasi nga, may anxiety na naman ako talaga. It helps, yung parang mas stabilized ka mentally because of the sense of security that you have around your partners. So parang I'm more happier, yun less worried, yung gayan. Sabi nga ng mga... yung mga yung mga tao na yung nammeet ko and in my in my line of work, it would be like, "you know what, you know what, [Nickname]?" Kasi nga, guys, yung real name ko, palayaw si [Nickname]. And siya, "Alam mo, [Nickname]? We never see you pouting or parang bad mood ka. You're always happy, you're always glowing," something like that. Because I am, because of the people that... you surround yourself with people that would help you grow and be a positive person, yung ganon. So my partners are those foundations that makes me... you know, happier. Parang ganon.

Interviewer: Yeah,thank you for that. So that's very, you know, I can see some kind of consistency in the way you articulate things, like the relationship's good for you because also yung previous answer that you said earlier about giving you that peace and that calm. Right. So now moving on, no? So this has something to do with your, maybe baka may yung overlaps, no? So feel free to say lang na if you've answered this question already. So given these relationships that you have, did these relationships change you? Yes or no? And then if yes, kindly qualify? Did the relationships change you in any way?

Speaker: I think that in any relationship, it always changed me. Ang ano lang, siguro ang difference lang is that yung the positiveness that it gives me yung ganon na yung, it would reinforce me to be more stable in the sense of yung parang nawawala yung anxiety ko and and also yung parang happier ka talaga

Interviewer: Yung happier ka. You're a happy person parang ganyan.

Speaker: Mas happy ako.

Interviewer: It's not really more on the ano kumbaga. Parang it's your state but in terms of let's say personalities or values et cetera, parang not much on that but it's really on you being a better person, a happier person, stable person.

Speaker: Kasi nga because with my current relationship I don't compromise eh. We're not in that state that we have to compromise and sacrifice. We're not in that point kasi so you are more secure in the relationship. So yung sinasabi ko lang na it's changing you in a way na more on you're happier with that sense na I don't have to be... to be another person so that I have a good relationship with my partner. I can just be me in this relationship and these people will not leave me. Parang ganyan na na like.

Interviewer: Thank you for that. So another quotable quote. Diba? So thank you for sharing that. Now i-reverse natin yung picture so you're saying that in a way there's some change in you're a happier person or stable. Now how about your partners? So, did they change at all during the relationship? So may nakita ka bang pagbabago from let's say before nung hindi pa kayo... hindi pa kayo couple. So, is the person you were before the relationship the same as the person that they are now.

Speaker: Siguro lang yung parang visible na nakita ka lang siguro when we are in our relationship, just more on nakita mo yung efforts nila to be a better... to be a better partner. Like your husband is trying to to work in a way na not to provide for the family, ganyan. So, they would try to be more... yung talagang they would perform in a way that yung parang at least macocompensate sila ganyan. And also siguro lang, ano si wife din, kasi ganon din siya. Yung kasi yung mga partner ko very workaholic people that sometimes I would say "ano ba kailangan ko ba na ikatlong relationship." Gumaganon na ko. Like I have [1-5] relationships and sometimes both of them are working. Like okay, pero ano lang siguro lang yung naintindihan mo naman nila in a sense they are trying to provide for the whole family, ganyan.

Speaker: Sa dati kasi parang hindi consistent yung direction nila parang, let us put it like more on yung direction nila na to reach a goal. Yung parang ganyan. Kasi parang wala silang goal sa life pero nung nasa relationship parang, okay, I have to achieve this kasi I am in a relationship right now. Usual kasi yan sa mga yung... I have to be financially stable for my family and provide for them pero sometimes you just remind them that it's okay... na ano lang.

Speaker: I even ask my husband, "you've been working so hard so where is that offset that you're supposed to be like... di ba you already told your boss that you're not gonna work because you've already worked last [Month Day]...no, [Day] of [Month] at saka nung [Day] ng [Month] so they promise you that you will have a four days na off ka so asan na yon." Naniningil ka or ganun, but they like to focus. And sometimes in financial, that you have to remind them that hindi lang yan yung aspect ng relationship that nagseselos na ko sa work ninyo.

Interviewer: So kumbaga parang mas ganun yung nakita mong pagbabago sa kanila. They became more devoted, provide for family.

Speaker: Yung may direction talaga na, you know, I want to do something so that I could, you know, help my family because we have a family na, ganyan. So, more on directional talaga, yung my goal sila nang gusto nila abutin. Yun sinasabi ko nang na "you're working hard" tapos sila magsasabi sila "oh yes you're also working too hard. Ilang ilang weekends ka na wala sa bahay kasi may may out of town." Yung ganyan.

Interviewer: So baka may similarity din pala na.. you yourself, you're actually a bit workaholic too.

Speaker: Yes, I'm actually very workaholic like the [1-5] of them but I'm trying to... stop yourself that working. That just because my family ka din, yung children have to provide care for the children, kasi ako yung main provider. Kasi ever since kasi yung the children was born breastfeed sila. So si mama talaga...yung I am always with them so parang if I'm not around within a week or ilang araw naghanap na yan na "mama where are you ba't hindi mo kami sinusundo sa school," ganiyan. So I am the workaholic na partner. Yung dalawa hindi ganon ka-workaholic but then it got reverse and I was like okay...and then I was trying to stop myself from working. And then "kayo naman dalawa yung nag work." So yun yung sinasabi ko na yung..."Patras lang tayong ha."

Interviewer: Not to the extent na nagiging cause naman siya ng mga problema sa relationship parang ganon.

Speaker: Hindi naman ano lang you have to also remind them, that take a break, take a break kasi nga but kasi yung isa laging nag-remind talaga. Kasi yung isa, yung husband kasi hindi naman siya yung kinoconfront ka talaga na, “oh you're always ganyan” na “you're not home,” ganyan. He's not that type, he was just like, “nobody's gonna take care of the children they're gonna miss you.” Hindi siya direct. Si wife naman kasi, siya mas direct siya, sinasabi niya “you're working too hard.” Like “No, you're gonna tell me I work too hard but you're the one who's actually working too hard.” Yun yung siya yung nagsasabi sa akin. So yun yung ano... dahan-dahan kasi na napupuna... na napupuna na nila na wala tayo sa bahay.

Interviewer: Pero parang na reverse naman parang ganyan.

Speaker: Na-reverse naman pero in essence, hindi naman talaga ano siya ano lang sometimes... sometimes they would focus. Sometimes kasi parang in the zone ka eh. Pag yung work mo na you're in the zone.. yung nga nang we're performing too well ganyan and sometimes you have to remind them, “are you guys working too hard ilang araw na kayo nagtatrabaho ganyan so you guys also need to a break ganyan,” pero siguro in a sense, relationship is like that naman then you remind them it's not healthy for you to work this hard.

Interviewer: Okay, alright. So thank you for that so parang kumbaga, for both naman, for you as well as for them, mayroon kong nakitang changes during the relationship. But not those kinds of changes na, let's say, detrimental or harmful to the relationship na naman. Now I would like to go back to something you said earlier. So let me just go back to my notes yung something about feelings of discomfort or yung not feeling so secure in your previous relationships. So, I'd like to ask... parang obvious yung sagot, but let me just ask this question. So, do you feel safe in your current relationships and why do you say so?

Speaker: Yes, I do feel safe in my current relationship. Why is it I say so because... siguro lang, siguro sa line of communication kasi namin when we feel something is like... something's wrong. Parang yung isa parang hindi niya...yung parang may sense of parang... iba yung kinikilos nila. Usually kasi you voice out yung...overthinking ba yung nag-overthink ka kasi ganyan, di ba. So, you tell them you verbalize. Na “parang may napapansin akong ganyan.” So, the line of communication is there so they would tell you na, “hindi ganito yan.” They would explain to you and you would understand the situation so it would give you more security then “Ay, hindi pala so I was jusy overthinking,” ganiyan.

Interviewer: So but in general kumbaga, parang yung nagcontribute para feelings of safety is there na may very open yung communication line. Alright. So, for the next part I will be sharing some slides. So, let me first prepare lang this one. So lakihan ko lang yung slideshow. So I have here [1-5] questions, actually three pero yung third question later ko pa itatanong. This is the first question, so ito yung statement, it's not really a question but more like a statement and you will try to answer the question by choosing from the numerical values. So, my partner usually really listens to me, so maybe we can identify. First si husband muna and then si wife. So what would your answer be, so from a range of 1 to 9... from a scale of 1 to 9, one as not at all true, nine as completely true. Ano kayang sagot mo diyen. So, if we go for the husband first.

Speaker: So, pag sinabi mong listen like in a conversation, they would totally be your attention will be on you or listen? Okay so... in a conversation siguro si husband talagang ano... moderately true. Kasi nga sometimes I have to repeat it 3 times.

Interviewer: Bago niya maintindihan or siguro... baka...

Speaker: Ano nadidistract siya, so yan, I have to repeat it like 3 times just to make sure that he gets it. Like, yung one time sabihin mo, he may might be not listening or nadistract siya. Second is like, okay. did you hear what I told you a while ago? Sabi ko ganyan ganyan, so you're gonna repeat it and then the third time bago niya bago pa aalis. Yun you have to repeat it again they would be reminded, this is either they were distracted or they forgot yun. Like sa conversation namin, yung babayad, ganyang like "babayaran mo yung bills ha." So, you have to remind them babayaran ng bills. Sometimes I even have to repeat it like 4 times through text. So ittext mo yan.

Interviewer: Madali siya madistract or.

Speaker: Makakalimutin, grabe yung makakalimutin talaga yun. So I have to repeat it so that they would be reminded... they would be reminded

Interviewer: Pero when it comes to let's say serious matters like for example, yung binanggit mo kanina na..like you do talks after a fight for example or after misunderstanding would your ratings still be in 5 or would it be something else?

Speaker: Definitely mga nasa 8 na yan, nasa 8 na yan

Interviewer: –pagdating sa mga seryoso.

Speaker: Kasi nga concern siya don eh. Talagang affected siya so yun. Tun yung level of concentration ay nags zero out talaga.

Interviewer: How about for the another partner?

Speaker: So in comparison for example si wifey, ganun din. 5 din siya kasi either she is very distracted, she is... she has ADHD like me so nadidistract talaga siya. Wala siyang focus at sometimes nakakalimot siya so I have to remind her like, "babe, did you did...you brought your house keys kasi baka malock la na naman sa bahay niyo, you have to wait for your roommate yun." So, you have to talk to her and remind her about stuff, yun.

Interviewer: Pero pag seryoso naman din, let's say katulad dun sa... although wala kayo masyadong fights, ano pero let's say if you are dealing with some serious conversation.

Speaker: Definitely, yun mga nasa 8 or 9 siya. Ano talaga mas very nakikinig talaga yung attention as if seryoso talaga. Her attention is really gonna be like listens to you, naobserve ko din yun kasi nga it was like, one time, "did you hear what I said," and she's like repeated everything I said.

Interviewer: So the next slide is ito kasi on the listening part, but how about when it comes to being responsive to your needs, so how would you rate them, so my partner usually is responsive to my needs. So ganun pa rin, so 1 to 9, with 1 as not at all true and 9 as completely true. So how would you rate them in terms of their responsiveness to your needs.

Speaker: Responsiveness to my needs...siguro alalang nasa 6 siguro yun si husband. Si husband yun 6 or 7 siguro kasi nga depende kasi... ano kaya... anong needs ba?

Interviewer: It's up to you.

Speaker: Siguro yung mga emotional support kasi ano siya... hindi kasi siya ganun ka ano... magaling makipag yung emotional, yung mga yung mga emotional na aspects, hindi siya magaling maka express. So, usually kasi yung emotional naman yung needs ko, yun. As long as I am able to eat 3 times a day I have some place to sleep, hindi naman ako yung...high maintenance na maraming kailangan sa buhay. Simple lang naman ako. More on kasi yung needs ko is emotional so yun. So yung problema lang kasi ni husband is nags-struggle siya if yung paano niya ishow yung emotional side niya.

Interviewer: So how about your wife?

Speaker: Si wife mas mataas medyo yung ratings niya in terms of responsive to my needs. Yung needs ko kasi I will just, I will just mostly... emotional support kasi yung kailangan ko, so yun si wife would rate around 7 or 8 talaga. Siya yung nagiging support system ko in that term. Pero kung sasabihin naman ng financial, si husband yung 7-8 siya. Si wifey kasi I don't usually ask anything na yung financials from her

Interviewer: Mas emotional needs. Although you were saying that your needs are really more kasi matimbang yung emotional.

Speaker: Emotional yung needs ko, kasi nga marami ako anxiety sa buhay. So yung emotional... yung parang emotional at saka yung mental needs lang yung kailangan ko with my partners, ayun. Kung sasabihin mo kasi yung needs kasi mas ako yung pupprovide sometimes sa kanila.

Interviewer: So I'll stop sharing for a while, may isa pang tanong but I'll show it in a bit. My next question ito yung medyo mas on physical intimacy and baka sensitive but feel free to tell me kung ready to answer ano man yung gusto mo to share about it. So I would like to know more about yung physical intimacy about your partners but more on your level of satisfaction when it comes to physical intimacy particularly let's say for sex, and the like. How often and also the frequency if you can just give me a general idea. Hindi naman kailangan into the details but more on your satisfaction about physical intimacy and sex and the frequency for example, in general. So pwede rin ano, pwede rin siguro by partner ulit if that's okay.

Speaker: I-rrate ulit?

Interviewer: Hindi naman... hindi naman scale kasi wala akong scale for that pero pwede siguro, ikaw, it's up to you if you want to put a scale or if it's going to easier for you to do .

Speaker: Yung physical ano lang siguro when it comes to intimacy talaga, I do enjoy sex. So like really enjoy it. Yes, I would really love if I could have it every day, yun. But si husband hindi namin talaga siya... kasi nga walang time gayan. So, maybe more on like yung physical intimacy siguro namin, more on siguro yung talaga yung...I would really love yung they would touch me and my body siguro. I always ask them na to massage me yan.

Interviewer: So mas ganoon yung nature nung physical intimacy mo...

Speaker: Ayun...right

Interviewer: How about for si wife?

Speaker: Siguro ano lang... kasi me and wife are in a very long distance relationship so usually, yan. We could see each other naked on camera. She would... she would tease me, and yeah ganoon. Of course there are times that, yes we would...people would call it... ano yun parang...parang phone sex but in in a video something like that, so yeah.

Interviewer: So, let's say so, of course there's that difference si husband it's...nandiyan siya physically and if you need... let's say physical intimate massage or the sex itself, perhaps easier to say it or ask for it or engage in it. So do you think this matters in the relationship?

Speaker: Siguro nga, sakin, like I said di naman... di ko naman talaga yung...yung yes it matters but it's not the whole... parang yung parang mas mabigat sa relationship. Like I would always tell my wife, I would even tell her that, because she's demisexual, so I told her that it's okay if you don't want to be like doing stuff like this because I understand. I understand you and you don't have to.

Interviewer: Can you explain a bit on that I'm not too familiar. Demi... demisexuals?

Speaker: Usually they are the people that would only engage in physical... like sex relationship if they are very close to that person. They don't feel sexually aroused, like we could be like sexually aroused with [Artist Name] or something like that in a certain scene, pero sila hindi. Kahit maghubad ka pa dyan and anong gagawin mo hindi sila... unless nalang may strong emotional attachment.

Interviewer: More on the connection.

Speaker: The more they are emotionally attached yung... yung they have feelings for you, yung they would feel the sexual attraction towards another person. But if wala... wala silang ganong klaseng emotional attachment parang nahihirapan sila but they can perform for their partner but they will not be satisfied sexually. So yun lang so I always tell my partner that, oh yes, I love sex but it's okay if both of you are not into that kasi nga it's different per person. So it's okay because that's not important in a relationship. Yung ano ko pa rin is like going back to security pa rin ako. I can feel secure like I'm not a bowl of anxiety person na every time I'm with my partners...

Interviewer: Okay sa I think I'm getting what you're saying, okay so thank you for that. Okay so now I'm actually down to the last question which I will show... show you again through a screen. Let me just try to share...right. So ito na yung sa satisfaction level. So this is more of a general question in terms of your satisfaction with your relationships. So again we will discriminate muna between either husband muna, and then your wife. So if you were to answer this question how satisfied are you with your relationship with the husband. So wala munang numeric value, so just choose your description muna from the list. So from completely dissatisfied and then very dissatisfied down to completely satisfied. What would your answer be?

Speaker: Siguro ano lang... somewhat satisfied.

Interviewer: Okay so SS. Right so in general to. And then for the wife what would your level of satisfaction?

Speaker: Yun somewhat... satisfied. Somewhat satisfied din.

Interviewer: Follow up question. So let me just check which slide, I will show you now. One moment lang ha. I will show you the third, teka lang ha. One two three...So medyo mahaba yung scale. So since you answered somewhat satisfied. Let me double check my... my kodigo if the answer is...here. How would you rate now your... your satisfaction if we are given let's say this numerical value. Would it be from... so may negative tayo na values tas may positive values din tayo, and then we have zero here so saan ka sa scale na yun?

Speaker: Siguro nasa... talaga... nasa ano five or six.Five or six for the husband.

Interviewer: For the husband first...

Speaker: Okay, for the husband... five or six.

Interviewer: Okay so somewhere there. And then for wife?

Speaker: Six and seven. Between that...

Interviewer: Between those values right...now if I can just go a bit further no. So you answered five or six for husband no...of course five and six is quite near to four, and of course six is quite near to seven. So if I can just prove a bit no. WHY not somewhere near seven for example or why not a little bit lower than five which is four?

Speaker: Siguro lang ano...five or six kasi nga you know they are the husband. For example he's with me you know but somehow...yun hindi naman kami ganun ka physically intimate with each other so yun. Kaya yung parang satisfaction level was between five or six lang talaga um yung parang nasa middle lang/

Interviewer: Understood, now for wife.

Speaker: Si wife kasi ano siya...

Interviewer: seven so it's near eight and of course six is a little bit on five then... so why choose this particular portion of the scale?

Speaker: Siguro na ano lang kasi...nakikita mo yung efforts ni wife eh. Like what I've said before that she would really rearrange her schedule sa mouth for you. Yung efforts pa, yung sa relationship na sometimes she would... she would sleep very late at night for you like 2-3 in the morning just to talk to you ganyun. So yung levels lang... ano lang talaga efforts niya for the relationship is talaga yung makikita mo even though she's not there. Pero yun...pero in all of this... yung ano lang... yung relationship siguro, sometimes yun. Kasi nga sabi ko medyo busy talaga yung mga tao na yan, you just wanted to be with them like for a day. Na you could be with them yun. Yun lang siguro yung nakaka.... na hindi ako medyo satisfied kasi I cannot be with them. Si husband kasi ano...ano kasi siya i understand kasi may mga bata din, parang nahahati din yun attention na if... if he has a sort of a break, ano ba yan... yung off time niya na yun nahahati siya. Na si wifey naman though you can have her ano lang talaga...yung wala naman talaga siyang mga anak but kasi nga the main point is that she's too far away from you. May limit din yung pakikipag interact. So yun, you cannot interact with her like that long so you would just interact with her sometimes, 12 minutes may get lucky, if we have a 3 hours na interaction with her in a day so ganiyan.

Interviewer: Okay. So, thank you for explaining the choice for... for the numbers. SO I'll stop sharing muna. Actually that's the final question but I need to ask... just yung sa consent part. So we're wrapping up but I'd like to... before we go into the consent part, I'll do a quick wrapping. Ayan so iwrarap ko lang, pero siyempre baka meron ako mga maling interpretations or...or maling notes ko so please feel free to correct me later. So I will not go through the demographics anymore but focus more on yung mga key concepts or key themes that you mentioned in the interview.

Interviewer: So in terms of relationship quality so let me narrow... narrow on that part you said that in terms of the comparison between the relationship quality that you have with your partners compared to that of your friends is that sabi mo parang ito yung sa mga friends mo, parang mas political yung foundation yung relationships, which it's not exactly the case with your partners. Also you did mention na halimbawa particularly for your husband, he's not that vocal when it comes to his emotions and hindi siya kasing PDA like your friends.

Interviewer: As for your wife... parang hindi masyado ito na-elaborate kanina, in terms of the differences but yung... yung basis... yung kanina yung sa mas political na differences. In terms of comparison as well parin ng relationship quality mo now compared to...yung mga previous mong relationships yung may discomfort hindi ganang ka-comfortable yung relationships. In the past hindi ganyang ka-secure mayroon ding na-trigger na anxiety which is not really the case for your present relationships. Mas calm, mas may order in the universe.

Interviewer: And then to distinguish now the high quality relationship from something that's low quality, sinabi mo ulit yung idea nung theme na may sense of security. Mas at peace, there's maturity. Not too much on the drama, not compromising. As for the low quality relationship sabi mo nga ang nakita mong pattern doon is that may compromises na ginagawa and that yung sacrifices on your part ay malaki, and you mentioned something a lot about yung...how to make it work kaya kailangan yung compromises and sacrifices. But the most important thing in the relationship, you emphasize on honesty. Particularly in the conversations, that it's important that you're on the same page and that nakikita nyo yung direction ng inyong relationship. And then love for you, as you said na malalim siyang...malalim siyang konsepto but the key ingredient or the key defining element of love is acceptance. The acceptance of the other person's acceptance of who you are, including the positive as well as the negative. And then...and that you said that love is quite really important because without love, no true relationship will stand. Sabi mo na it will not last long and you know that your partner loves you because you actually feel that they care, you really feel their presence in your life, that kind of sensitivity in your life.

Interviewer: And then in terms of challenges or conflicts, nabanggit mo na mas present yung mga misunderstanding, especially sa unang part ng relationship with husband, and the nature nito is really yung selos being... dahil di naman siya...he's non-poly and therefore it took a while for him to also, of course, understand yung ganong setup, right? And you also said that some of the challenges is also balancing the relationship to make sure no one is left out. As to how these are dealt with, the fights or the misunderstandings, are dealt with through re-assurance and usually this happens of course by talking with your partner. So andun yung mga conversations ninyo.

Interviewer: And in terms of maintaining the relationship sabi mo nga, you make sure that nothing's changed in the relationships na normal yung mga relationships, and that... to ensure that there's physical intimacy, and show of affection. And then I also ask you about whether the relationship is good

for you and your answer is yes. You feel the love from the relationships and at the same time in terms of your personal stability nakita mo yung stability in these relationships lower anxiety levels. You mentioned that you're happier, you're less worried and there's growth in the relationship as well as within you.

Interviewer: And then did the relationship change the other person, and you said na any relationship will change a person...but you saw that you also saw the efforts of your partner. Kung mayron ka mga nakitang pagbabago sa kanila, their efforts to be better partner and also to provide. Like Halimbawa yung na-mensyong mo din something about them being a bit more workaholic or being more focused in their work. Now as far as relationships safeties concern, you said that, yes. You feel safe in the relationships and I think ang key element na binanggit mo dito was the line of communication is open, it's there and there's that opportunity to verbalize yung thoughts and feelings or to voice out.

Interviewer: And then we went to some kind of yung mga... yung mga questions na you had to give a scale for a partner as being able to listen. You gave husband a five, a five for the less serious talks but for the more serious once you gave him an eight. Similar for the wife, but si wife sa serious talks you gave her a bit more higher like eight or nine. For responsiveness to your needs, you said kung sa financial you'll give your husband like seven or eight, for emotional, six or seven. For wife, you gave her seven or eight for providing the support system.

Interviewer: And then as far as sex is concerned you said that you do enjoy sex of course but, of course, si husband who might be a bit busy also, so less on the physical intimacy. But you like being touched, like massages. And wife, of course, because of the nature is, of course, learning long distance relationship, there's of course opportunities for physical intimacy. Like through video or how do you say it... like through video calls. Okay, pero kumbaga, you did mention it's not really the main ingredient in the relationship but you would always go back for pa rin dun sa security. The feelings of security in the relationship.

Interviewer: And finally the last question is on global satisfaction and in terms of global satisfaction or general satisfaction with the relationship, your answer is on the SS, or the somewhat satisfied for husband and the reason for this is because mas less on the physical intimacy and just for that reason. And for the wife naman it's also somewhat satisfied, but in terms of the rating it's between 6 or 7 because you can really see yung effort din nya to actually make effort for you, and to be more sensitive when there are particular emotional... specific to emotional needs.

Interviewer: Right, so is there anything that you'd like to correct or add or qualify further?

Speaker: Siguro lang sa ano... sa parang sa first question ata yung difference between my relationships and my friends, si wife kasi parang wala naman yung specific... siguro ano lang... si wife so she's a little bit political but she's more of a cheesy romantic type of person, like she's that she's very cheesy and romantic. So you would she would just tell you something really sweet and you would like... like there's like one time that I was like driving a motorcycle and she told me that, "you have to be like can be safe," something like that. And I'm like "being safe don't worry about me," and she was like, "it's my job to worry about you because I'm your wife." So nobody had ever told me like, "oh it's my job to worry about you because I'm in a relationship with you," or something like that. And I was like I was about to cry when I was like driving but, you know, it's not safe to cry so I was like, "you're... you're romantically cheesy right now," something like that. She would say something like...

Interviewer: I remember because I also have a daughter, and and my daughter would always tell me that same line, that you don't have to worry about me, and I would tell her it's my job to worry about you something like that. Okay, so kind of relatable but in a different context.

Speaker: Yeah, the thing is you know... if husband isn't really that showy about his relationship... I mean his emotions or vocal enough about his feelings, wifey is the opposite of that. She's very vocal and she would... she would say something very romantic and you would just be like, "okay, I didn't expect you to say that but you said that." And you know you can't help but fall in love with the person because of that, but with husband because.... ano din siya... yung sense of... yung presence talaga niya, yung na although he is not that vocal but when he sense that you are in discomfort or you're... yung talaga yung anxiety level because it's too high, he would just... even though he's not really at touchy person he would just be like hug you... and reassure you that you're not alone in this sort of part of your life where you are feeling that type of emotion.

Interviewer: So yung so kumbaga both naman would really respond to you, but in different ways parang ganon. So thank you for adding that. Is there anything else that you would like to qualify or add?

Speaker: Siguro wala na po, yun na po.

Interviewer: Yeah so medyo na pahaba rin tayo, no? Because of course when you talk about love and relationships, it really is very personal. It's quite easier to explain it when you come up with examples and of course definitely I appreciate that.

Interviewer: Now before we end, so yung isang gusto kung i-clarify with you is the option, what option you prefer in terms of sharing the transcription. So definitely there will be a transcription of our session but the point is yung ishshare sa open science portal. Is it do you want the entire transcription to be made available, but definitely redacted yung mga identifying information like names and places, kung may namention man tayong mga places kanina. So this will be identified and this can be read by other researchers. The other option, so that's actually option 2, that's the bolder option kasi kumbaga yung buong transcription... the way we talk will be made available. Option 1 is that transcript portions can be shared. Again none will be identified to you but these are transcript portions which means kung among relevant lang to the questions that I asked earlier. Yeah, so but I don't know it's quite difficult also to narrow down but kung halimbawa when I talk about my own kwento that will be redacted already, but what do you prefer, the bolder option 2 or option 1?

Speaker: Siguro ano lang because I'm ano...a person who believes in science and if it helps... So I would... I would be happy to share the whole thing na without censorship or something, except for the names of course. But yung ano lang siguro yung it could help... if it could help, yes, I would I would give permission to everyone to use it.

Interviewer: Okay, number 2.

Speaker: Number 2 option.

Interviewer: Thank you so much, So definitely naman redacted talaga yan kasi ito na yung trend sa open science kasi we want to make sure na transparent, and then researchers can actually read also. And if they ask permission... I think they can again... I don't know... they can reanalyze perhaps the transcriptions yan.

Speaker: I think it's okay naman kasi your questions are very ano naman... hindi naman siya...I know it's personal... hindi naman siya disrespectful and I think that any person out there who would be having questions, like this type of question, probably it would help them somehow. So I would really love to share it to the world if it could, you know, if it would help someone... an individual out there. So yun okay lang talaga. Okay lang, number 2 yung option.

Interviewer: Thank you so much, yes it really ends our session. So again, let me just go through my script. So thank you for participating in the study. And, of course, I mentioned this, so this is also being done in, of course, in the Philippines. It's being done in Brazil, Turkey, France and the US so medyo... yung iba advance na. Tapos na sa kanilang data collection and then, of course, if you have any questions I think I sent it in the email, kung may tanong so directly ask me the question about the research or we can always refer it to Miguel... to Miguel Sinan who is the project leader.

Speaker: So a question lang po, after everyone is done with their research is there a possibility that we could have a copy of the final paper?

Interviewer: Right ang alam ko. There is.... nandun yun sa consent form... at double check pa. And of course always feel free to.... ako... ano ko din naman yan so... if I promise to give a the results halimbawa ako yung project leader, definitely it will be made available. But sometimes it's in the condensed form, you know, but if the article is available like, you know, it's it's a... how do you say it... it's an open source material then it can also be downloaded. But yeah, so parang yun naman yung direction. It has to be published, but hindi yung unang publication... I think hindi siya ganon ka-detalyado and then kami, halimbawa for example kami sa Philippines, kami yung team na yun. So we can actually come up with a more detailed analysis of the results, like focusing on relationship quality pero mas Philippine context kasi nga yun yung familiar kaming data. But in the consent let me double check... but I actually I sent it. Yeah, okay so sabi nga rin dito, so if you have actually the right to access your data and to rectify it pero that can be addressed through... kasi ang may hawak talaga nung kabuuan ng data is, of course, through Miguel Silan. And then if you...if you want the results I will note that. We will be meeting again next week so I will note that. Of course, Maganda na mabasa nyo yung final ano....

Speaker: Okay lang din yung na publish na na paper yung... “ah ganun pala yun.” na ganun. Ganito pala yung nangyari.

Interviewer: Kumbaga yung data din from, let's say other countries, maganda din...it would be interesting to know also kung ano yung patterns or themes na lumabas sa kanila when it comes to relationship quality.

Interviewer: Thank you so much, anything else before we say goodbye and we end our zoom meeting?

Speaker: Ah, wala na po. Yun lang talaga, yung baka pwede makabasa dun sa final paper na na-publish na, yun lang talaga.

Interviewer: Oh okay. Feel free to communicate with me lang. Kapag lumabas naman I'll also let you know, baka kung andiyan lang yung link to the article then I will share also the link to all my... yung mga na interview ko.

Speaker: Sige po, salamat din po.

Interviewer: I hope you have... still be able to have a good day and restful day.

Speaker: Sige po, salamat po.

Interviewer: Thank you

Speaker: Sige po. Bye. Paano ba to? I do not know how to stop...

Interviewer: I can just end it.

Speaker: Sige po.

Interviewer: Bye.

Speaker: Bye po.